G-D-3310
June 28, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. G-D-00331C (GSA-FSS)
September 29, 1969, and
Fed. Spec. G-D-331
April 17, 1942

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DICTIONARIES, ENGLISH

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers English dictionaries, furnished with or without cutout thumb indexes, as specified (see 6.2).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. The dictionaries shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Minimum of 30,000 entries.
Type II - Minimum of 130,000 entries.
Type III - Minimum of 400,000 entries.
Type IV - Minimum of 200,000 entries.

1.2.1.1 Classes. The dictionaries shall be of the following classes as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1 - With cutout thumb indexes.
Class 2 - Without cutout thumb indexes.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Methods:

T 401m - Fiber Analysis of Paper and Paperboard.
T 402os - Conditioning Paper and Paperboard for Testing.
T 403ts - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T 410os - Basis Weight of Paper and Paperboard.
T 414ts - Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper.
T 425m - Opacity of Paper.
T 452os - Brightness of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10017.)

Manufacturing Standards and Specifications for Textbooks.

(Application for copies should be addressed to Textbook Specifications, P.O. Box 368, Ridgefield, CT 06877.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard product. Each dictionary offered shall be the publisher's standard product which is available nationally through bookstores, or sold to schools or universities. The dictionaries shall be the latest copyrighted editions. Jackets are not required.

3.2 Updating and revision. All dictionaries offered shall have been updated within the last three years from date of invitation to bid. Type I, II, and IV dictionaries shall have been revised within the last twelve years from date of invitation to bid. Updating of a dictionary shall entail updating entries and adding new entries and senses. Revision of a dictionary shall entail updating, and page-by-page rewrite. All dictionaries shall contain at least the minimum number of words specified in 4.3.3.2 and 4.3.3.3, as applicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3 Material and construction. Unless otherwise specified, the printing, binding, cover board, and cover shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Manufacturing Standards and Specifications for Textbooks for the applicable class (see 6.3). The sewing shall be Smyth-type sewn. The book paper used in dictionaries shall be in accordance with table I.

TABLE I. Paper requirements

Characteristic	Type I	Type II	Type III	Type IV
Fiber (percent of bleached chemical woodpulp)	100	100	100	100
Bursting strength (min. points)	9	9	9	9
Basis weight (lbs.) (25 by 38 inches - 500 sheets)	40 ± 5 percent	30 ± 5 percent	35 ± 5 percent	35 ± 5 percent
Tearing resistance (min. avg. grams in each direction)	25	18	30	20
Opacity (percent min.)	90	80	86	86
Brightness (percent min.)	70	75	73	75

3.3.1 Thumb index. When specified (see 1.2.1.1 and 6.2), dictionaries shall be supplied with the number of cutout thumb indexes as follows:

Type I - Not less than eight (8) thumb indexes.
Type II - Not less than twelve (12) thumb indexes.
Type III - Not less than fifteen (15) thumb indexes.
Type IV - Not less than twelve (12) thumb indexes.

The index tabs shall firmly adhere to the pages, and the tabs shall be legibly and durably lettered.

3.4 Printing. The printing shall be clear and legible, and the main terms shall be printed in boldface type, or contrasting type style.

3.5 Content (all types). The dictionaries shall contain the specified minimum number of entries (terms) specified (see 1.2 and 6.2), when examined as specified in 4.3.3 and 4.3.3.1. The dictionaries shall alphabetically list vocabulary terms of the English Language and adequately identify the phonetic, grammatical and semantic values of the terms. Specifically, the dictionaries shall contain at least the applicable requirements specified in table II. Each dictionary shall include a general guide for its proper usage, and key to pronunication.

TABLE II. Content requirements

Requirements	Type I	Type II	Type III	Type IV
Definitions (the definitions shall be clear and accurate, and new senses of existing and new words shall be clearly defined)	---	---	---	---
Pronunciation of the main terms by respelling using a defined system of phonetic transcription and stress marks.	---	---	---	---
End-of-line division (syllabication)	---	---	---	---
Part, or parts of speech of each term with part-of-speech headings	---	---	---	---
Inflected and derived forms, when such exist and are commonly encountered	---	---	---	---
Pictorial illustrations, when needed for added clarification	---	---	---	---
Etymologies of the main terms, when such are known		---	---	---
Synonyms, when distinguishing them is useful		---	---	---
Variant spelling, when such exist and are commonly encountered		---	---	---
Commonly used slang and colloquial terms.		---	---	---
Commonly used technical and scientific words		---	---	---

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.1 Type I. The dictionary shall contain at least sixteen (16) of the twenty (20) terms stated in 4.3.3.2.

3.5.2 Types II, III, and IV. The dictionaries shall contain at least forty-eight (48) of the sixty (60) terms stated in 4.3.3.3.

3.6 Identification marking. The outside of the cover shall be legibly and permanently marked with the publisher's name or trademark.

3.7 Workmanship. The dictionaries shall be free from frayed edges, tears, cuts, holes, wrinkles, creases, lumps, discolorations, jagged or irregular edges, distortions, extraneous foreign matters, smudges or fauly construction.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Testing of materials and construction. The supplier is responsible for insuring that the binding, sewing, cover board, and cover were manufactured and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specification, standards and other documents. The book paper shall be tested in accordance with the applicable TAPPI tests specified.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All dictionaries of the same type and class presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination and tests.

4.2.2 Sampling for examination and tests. Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual examination. Dictionaries shall be taken at random from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one dictionary. The dictionaries shall be examined for defects listed in table IV. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Sampling for entry count and new words. One sample unit shall be taken at at random from each lot, and examined as specified in the applicable paragraphs in 4.3.3, 4.3.3.1, 4.3.3.2, and 4.3.3.3.

4.2.6 Sampling for base material. A lot shall consist of one shipment of paper for book paper and received at one time from one source of supply and shall be expressed in pounds of paper. The sample units shall be one (1) square yard of paper. The sample unit shall be selected from each lot of paper in accordance with table III.

TABLE III. Sample size

Lot size (Pounds)	Sample size (Square yards)
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table IV. Any dictionary having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE IV. Visual examination

Examine	Defects
Type and class	Dictionary not of the type or class as specified (see 1.2.1 and 1.2.1.1).
Standard product	Dictionary not standard product (see 3.1).
Updating and revision	Dictionary not updated and revised (see 3.2).
Thumb index	Thumb indexes, if required, not as specified (see 3.3.1).
Printing	Printing not as specified (see 3.4).
Content	Content not as specified (see 3.5).
Identification Marking	Identification marking not as specified (see 3.6).
Workmanship	Workmanship not in accordance with 3.7.

4.3.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine whether packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table V.

TABLE V. Inspection for preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not conforming to the applicable specification or requirements stated herein.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior container)	Quantity per container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceed requirements of the box specification.

4.3.3 Entries and new words count. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the following examinations. Any dictionary not meeting the entry or new word requirements shall be rejected, and the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3.3.1 Entries. To determine the number of entries, select ten representative vocabulary pages at random and count the number of entries of each page. Divide the total number of entries by ten to determine the average number of entries per page. Then multiply the average number of entries by the number of vocabulary pages in the dictionary, to assure minimum entry requirements (see 1.2). This test may be repeated one time, if the dictionary fails the entry requirements. The entry count shall include the following: (1) Main entry words, whether single word, hyphenated form, or phrase; (2) Each defined part of speech of main term; (3) Inflected forms (plural of nouns, past and past participial verb parts, and comparative and superlative forms of adjectives and adverbs); (4) Variant spellings; (5) Run-on entries; (6) Idioms; (7) Words with affixes.

4.3.3.2 Terms, type I. Check the dictionary for inclusion of at least sixteen (16) terms of the following twenty (20) terms as specified in 3.5.1:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

1. computer
2. escalator
3. fluorescent lamp
4. fluoridation
5. guided missile
6. H-bomb
7. jet plane, jet airplane, or jet engine
8. laser
9. launch pad, or launching pad
10. lift-off
11. Medicare
12. NATO
13. penicillin
14. spacecraft or spaceship
15. sputnik
16. stereophonic
17. subway
18. supersonic
19. UN, or U.N.
20. Zipe Code, ZIP Code, or zip code

4.3.3.3 Terms, types II, III, and IV. Check the dictionary for inclusion of at least forty-eight (48) of the sixty (60) terms, as specified in 3.5.2.:

1. acrylic resin
2. aerospace
3. Afro
4. antimissile missile
5. backlash
6. ballistic missile
7. ball-point pen
8. beatnik
9. bioastronautics
10. Black Muslim
11. brainwash, or brainwashing
12. CIA
13. civil defense
14. Common Market
15. computer
16. counterinsurgency
17. credit card
18. data processing
19. detente
20. DNA
21. drip-dry
22. escalate
23. fluorescent lamp
24. fluoridation
25. genocide
26. gobbledygook, or gobbledegook
27. guided missile
28. H-bomb
29. hippie, or hippy
30. hot line
31. hydrofoil
32. ICBM or I.C.B.M.
33. karate
34. laser
35. launch pad, or launching pad
36. lift-off
37. Medicare
38. NATO
39. overkill
40. pacesetter, or pacemaker
41. payola
42. Peace Corps
43. penicillin
44. Plexiglas
45. retrorocket
46. RNA
47. rock 'n' roll, or rock-and-roll
48. rotary engine
49. seat belt
50. SEATO
51. snowmobile
52. spacecraft, or spaceship
53. sputnik
54. stereophonic
55. subway
56. superpower
57. supersonic
58. UN, or U.N.
59. Xerox
60. Zip Code, ZIP Code, or zip code

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Tests for book paper. Samples obtained in accordance with 4.2.6 shall be subjected to the following tests. Failure to pass any one test shall be considered cause for rejection of the entire lot as not meeting the material requirements of this specification. The physical properties of the book paper shall be tested in accordance with the TAPPI test methods listed in table VI. All samples shall be conditioned and tested under uniform atmospheric conditions as specified in TAPPI test method T 402os.

TABLE VI. Test methods

Physical properties	TAPPI test methods
Fiber Analysis of Paper and Paperboard.	T 401m
Conditioning Paper and Paperboard for Testing.	T 402os
Bursting Strength of Paper.	T 403ts
Basis Weight of Paper and Paperboard.	T 410os
Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper.	T 414ts
Opacity of Paper.	T 425m
Brightness of Paper and Paperboard.	T 452os

4.4.2 Binding, cover board, and cover. The binding, sewing, cover board, and cover shall be tested in accordance with the Official Manufacturing Standards and Specification for Textbooks to assure compliance with the requirement stated in 3.3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each dictionary shall be packaged in accordance with method IC-2 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Level B. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) no packaging shall be required for level B. When specified, each dictionary shall be packaged in accordance with method III of MIL-P-116.

5.1.3 Level C. The dictionaries shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Dictionaries of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities as specified (see 6.2) in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I. Ten type I dictionaries shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.2.2.2 Type II. Eight type II dictionaries shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.2.2.3 Type III or IV. Two type III or IV dictionaries shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.2.3 Level C. The dictionaries packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed to comply with the National Motor Freight Classification Rules or the Uniform Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The dictionaries are intended as a general reference source for words of the English language.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Whether packaging in accordance with method III of MIL-P-116 is required (see 5.1.2).
(e) Quantity of unit packages required in shipping container (see 5.2.1).
(f) Whether civil or military marking is required (see 5.3).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 Class. "Class" referenced in 3.3 designates the classification adopted by the Official Manufacturing Standards and Specifications for Textbooks and is determined by the bulk measurement of the book, exclusive of cover.

NO OFFICIAL DOD INTEREST HAS BEEN REGISTERED

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 25 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.